

DESIGN REVIEW • V6 • INTERNAL

3GPP UE Root Cause Analysis Skill Suite – Version 6

Per-level iterative Fault Tree Analysis with user-gated top event selection and iteration-by-iteration checkpoints. Built for Cline (VS Code) without MCP.

VERSION

SKILLS

v6.0 (baseline) 12 + 1 workflow + 1 rule

FILES

STATUS

33 (5 shared, 24 skill, 2 control, 2 wrapper) Built · Pre-test

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§01 What changed in v6

v6 introduces **per-level iterative FTA**. v5 ran one fault tree top-to-bottom and emitted one root cause. v6 runs N iterations of FTA, each producing an iteration-local root cause; the user decides at each checkpoint whether to dig deeper or accept the current finding as terminal. The pipeline halts at **three to N+1 user gates** per run (one Checkpoint A, N Checkpoint Bs).

V5 MODEL

- One `phase3_hybrid_tree`
- One `phase3_root_cause`
- No user gates (halt-on-error only)
- Top event set automatically
- 10 skills + workflow + rule

V6 MODEL

- `fta_iterations[]` – one per drill level
- `phase3_root_cause_chain` synthesized at terminal
- Checkpoint A (top event) + Checkpoint B per iteration
- Top event chosen from curated `top_event_candidates[]`
- 12 skills (added top-event-confirmation, iteration-controller)

DESIGN DECISIONS LOCKED IN V6.0

D1 • ITERATION BUDGET

5

Default cap; user can override into iteration 6+ via explicit confirmation

D2 • FAST MODE**DROPPED**

Every iteration requires user gate – no auto-accept escape valve

D3 • TOP EVENT ALTERNATIVES**≤3 candidates**

1 primary + up to 2 defensible alternatives; no padding with hallucinated alts

D4 • USER OVERRIDE**ALLOWED**

With explicit "confirm override" prompt; logged with `override_recommendation` flag

D5 • CROSS-ITER CROSS-REF**DEFERRED**

Iteration $N+1$ doesn't cross-ref against iteration N 's commanded values – v6.1

D6 • BUILD STRATEGY**FULL REBUILD**

All 12 SKILL.md files rewritten from scratch – no patching v5 in place

COST HONESTY

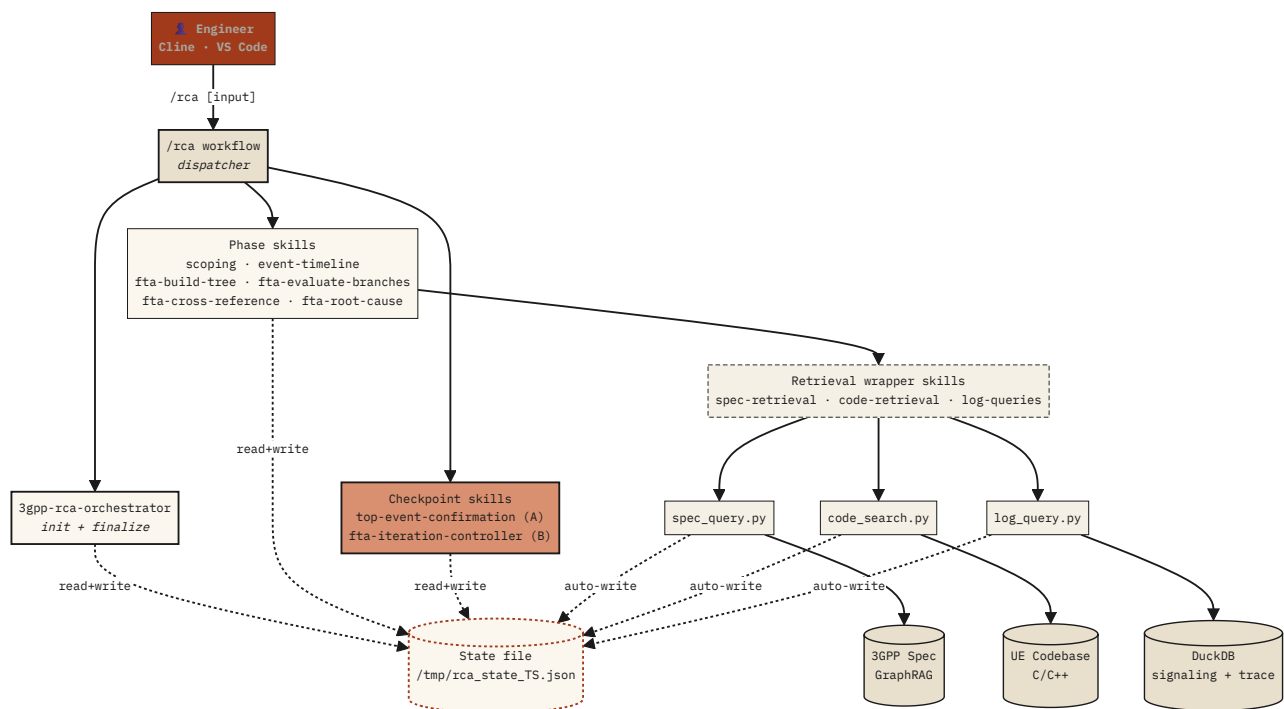
A typical 3-iteration run costs roughly **2× the tokens** and **3.5× the wall-clock** of an equivalent v5 run. The wall-clock multiplier is dominated by user pause times (one pause per iteration plus Checkpoint A). v6 is the right answer if the failure mode you most want to prevent is the agent *confidently producing wrong root causes*. If your dominant cost is engineer time, v5's autonomous run is faster.

§02 Four-layer architecture

Five layers separated by clear contracts: the engineer interacts only with Cline's `/rca` workflow; the workflow dispatches to skills; skills delegate retrieval to wrapper skills; wrapper skills exec Python scripts; scripts talk to the underlying data stores. The state file is the cross-cutting source of truth — every layer reads and writes to it via slice operations.

FIG. 1 — SYSTEM LAYERS AND DATA FLOW

FIG-01



WHY A DISPATCHER WORKFLOW?

In v5 the `/rca` workflow ran linearly start-to-finish. In v6 the pipeline must *halt at user gates*. Each `/rca` invocation reads `meta.current_phase` from the state file and runs only the next step — then halts. This makes the pipeline resumable from any checkpoint and lets the user respond to a gate by typing `/rca <option>` in a fresh turn.

§03 Skill catalog

12 skills grouped into four roles. Orchestration runs once at the start and once at the end. Phase skills do the actual analysis work. Checkpoint skills handle user gates. Retrieval skills are thin wrappers around the Python tools.

ORCHESTRATION • 1 SKILL

3gpp-rca-orchestrator

Phase 0
init +
Phase 4
finalize

CHECKPOINT • 2 SKILLS

NEW V6

3gpp-top-event-confirmation

Checkpoint A – top event

3gpp-fta-iteration-controller

Checkpoint B – per iteration

PHASE • 6 SKILLS

3gpp-scoping

Phase 1 – IS/IS-NOT scope filter

V5 VERBATIM

3gpp-event-timeline

Phase 2 – timeline + top_event_candidates[]

V6 AMENDED

3gpp-fta-build-tree

Phase 3.1 – hybrid tree per iteration

V6 AMENDED

3gpp-fta-evaluate-branches

Phase 3.2 + 3.3 – Gate A pruning + Gate B verification

V6 AMENDED

3gpp-fta-cross-reference

Phase 3.4 – commanded vs actual value

V6 AMENDED

3gpp-fta-root-cause

Phase 3.5 – iteration root cause synthesis

V6 AMENDED

RETRIEVAL WRAPPERS • 3 SKILLS

V5 VERBATIM

3gpp-spec-retrieval

Wraps spec_query.py (6 operations)

3gpp-code-retrieval

Wraps code_search.py (3 operations)

3gpp-log-queries

Wraps log_query.py (5 phase tags)

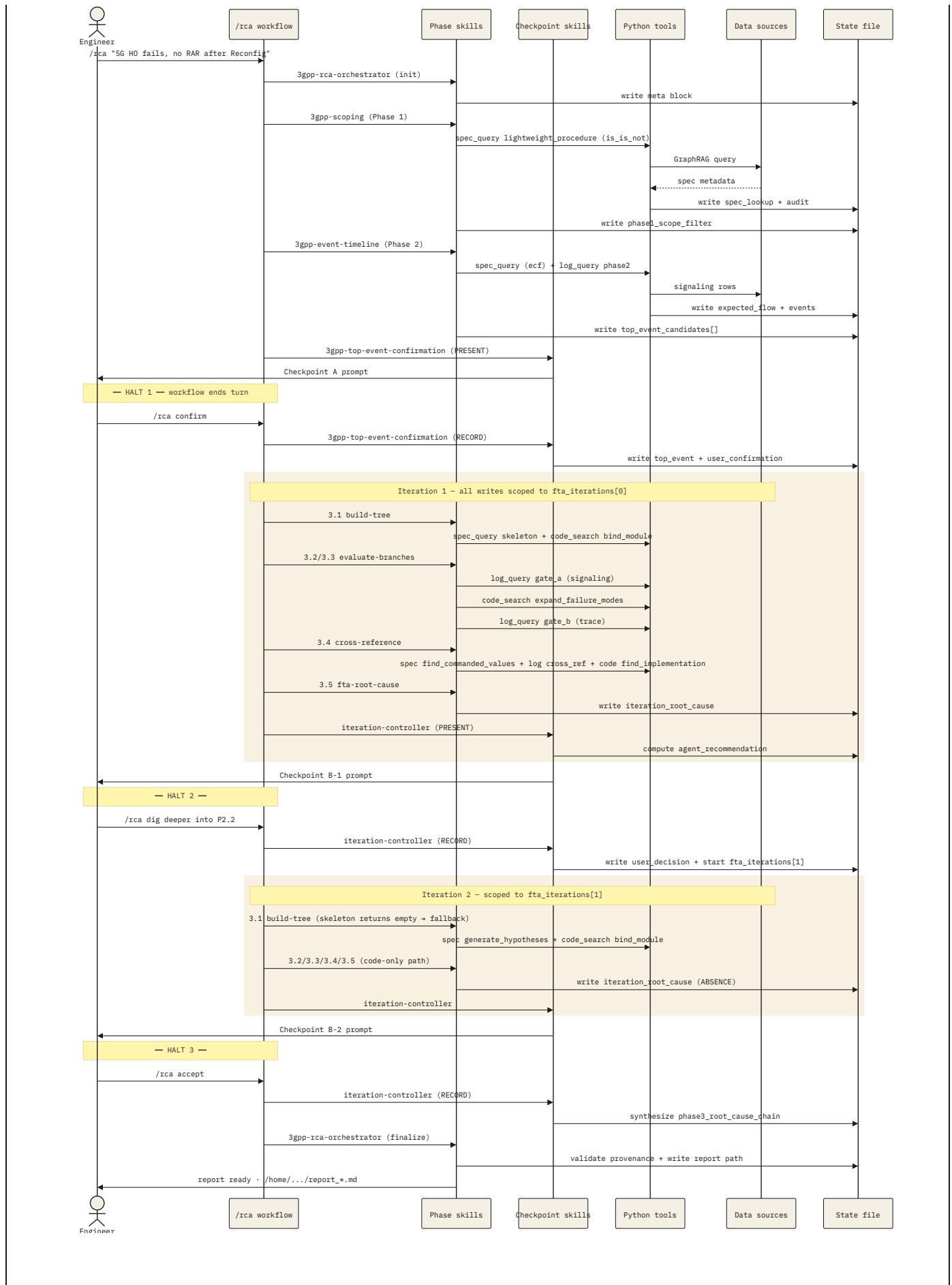
Plus one always-on rule (`3gpp-rca-collaboration.md`) and one workflow file (`/rca`), and five shared resources in `_shared/` .

§04 End-to-end sequence

The diagram below shows a realistic two-iteration run from `/rca` trigger to final report. Notice the three HALT points where the workflow ends a turn and waits for the user.

FIG. 2 — END-TO-END SEQUENCE (2-ITERATION EXAMPLE)

FIG-02



READING THIS DIAGRAM

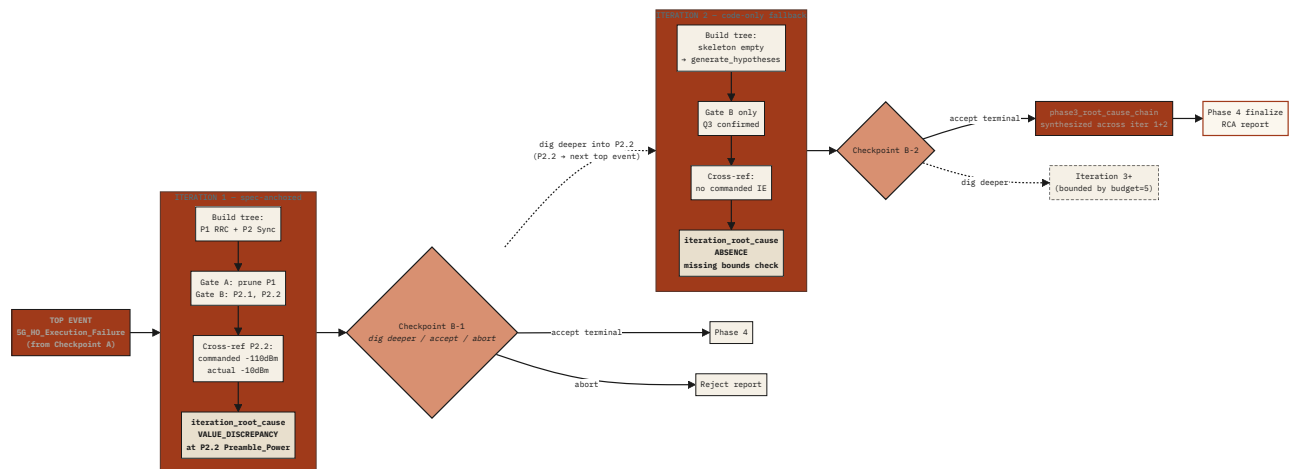
The three **HALT** annotations are where the agent's turn literally ends. The user must send a new `/rca` message to resume. The state machine in §06 explains how the workflow knows where to resume.

§05 Iteration model

The central concept of v6: **one FTA iteration = one full Phase 3.1→3.5 cycle** over a single input top event, producing one iteration-local root cause. Iterations chain together – iteration N's user-selected base event becomes iteration N+1's input top event.

FIG. 3 – ITERATION CHAINING (CAUSAL CHAIN)

FIG-03



WHAT CHANGES AT EACH ITERATION BOUNDARY

ITERATION 1 (TYPICAL)

- `input_top_event.source = phase2_ecf.top_event`
- `spec_anchored: true`
- Skeleton populates branches (spec phases)
- Gate A signaling drives pivot-pruning
- Likely `VALUE_DISCREPANCY` or `MULTI_CAUSE`

ITERATION $\geq$ 2 (TYPICAL)

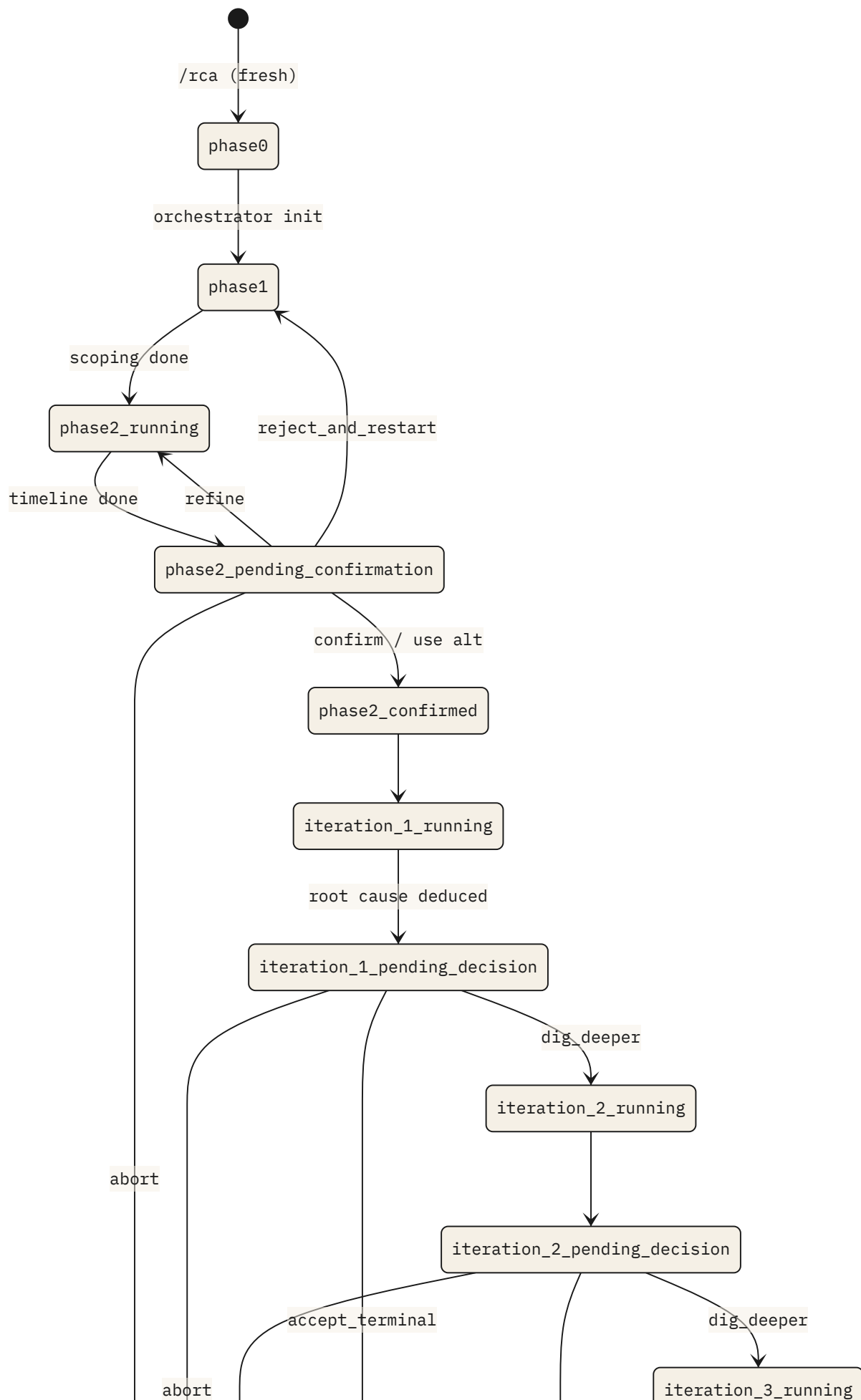
- `input_top_event.source = fta_iterations[N-1].base_events[id]`
- `spec_anchored: false`
- Skeleton often empty $\rightarrow$ `fallback_used: generate_hypotheses`
- Gate A skipped on code-only branches
- Likely ABSENCE; eventually terminal

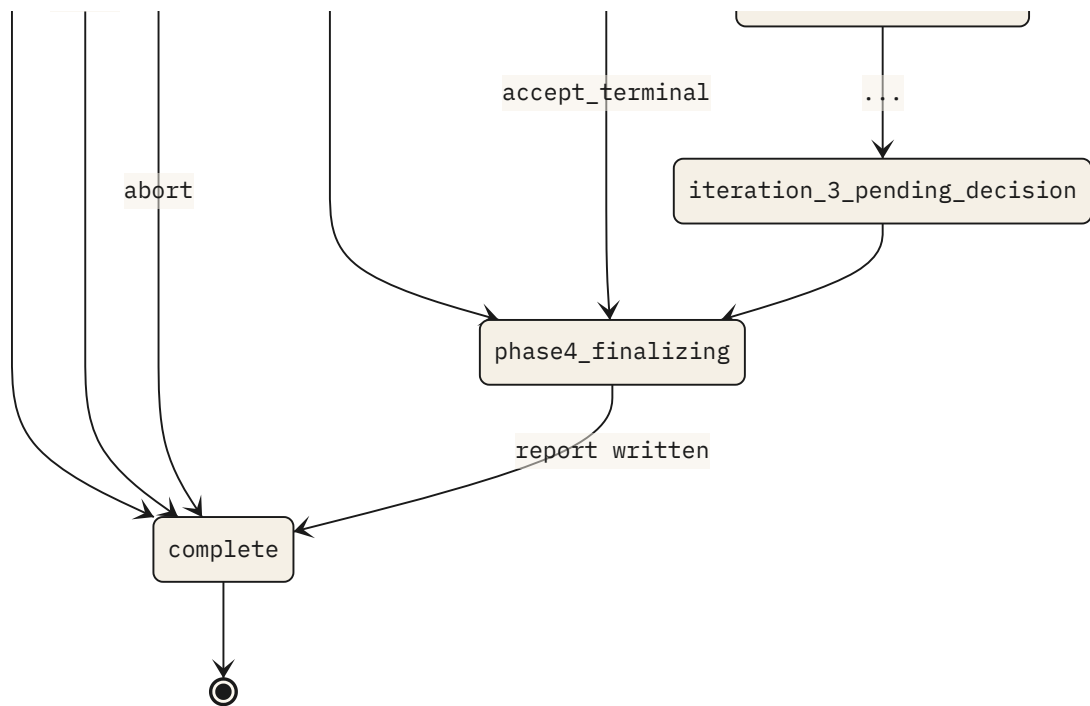
§06 State machine

The workflow dispatcher reads `meta.current_phase` from the state file on every `/rca` invocation and runs the next applicable step. Every skill writes the next-phase value before halting or returning.

FIG. 4 — META.CURRENT_PHASE TRANSITIONS

FIG-04





RESUMABILITY

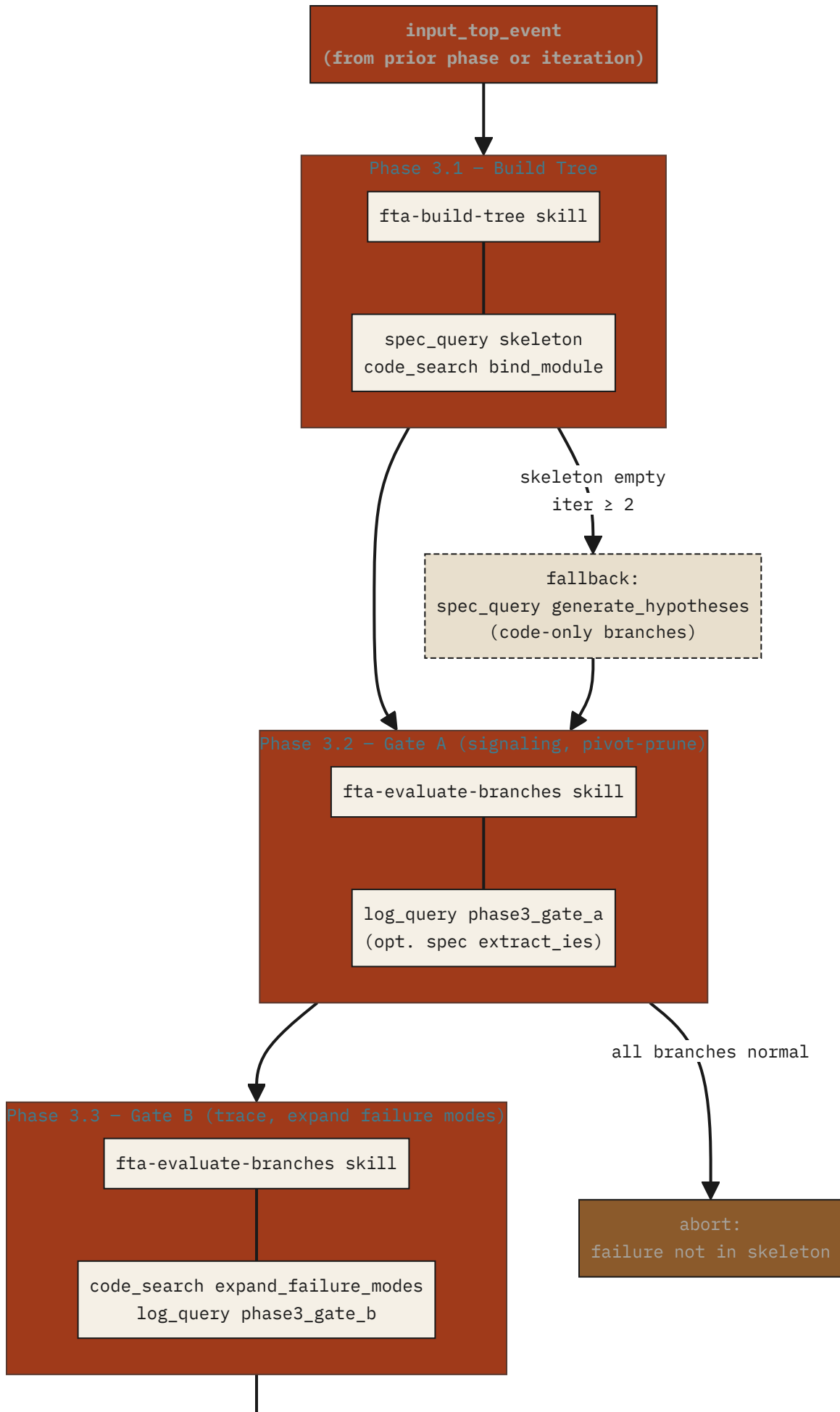
If the Cline task dies mid-iteration, the state file still has `meta.current_phase = "iteration_N_running"` and partial writes in `fta_iterations[N-1]`. The next `/rca` picks up from the last-completed sub-phase. This is why every phase skill is idempotent – it checks what's already in the iteration record before redoing work.

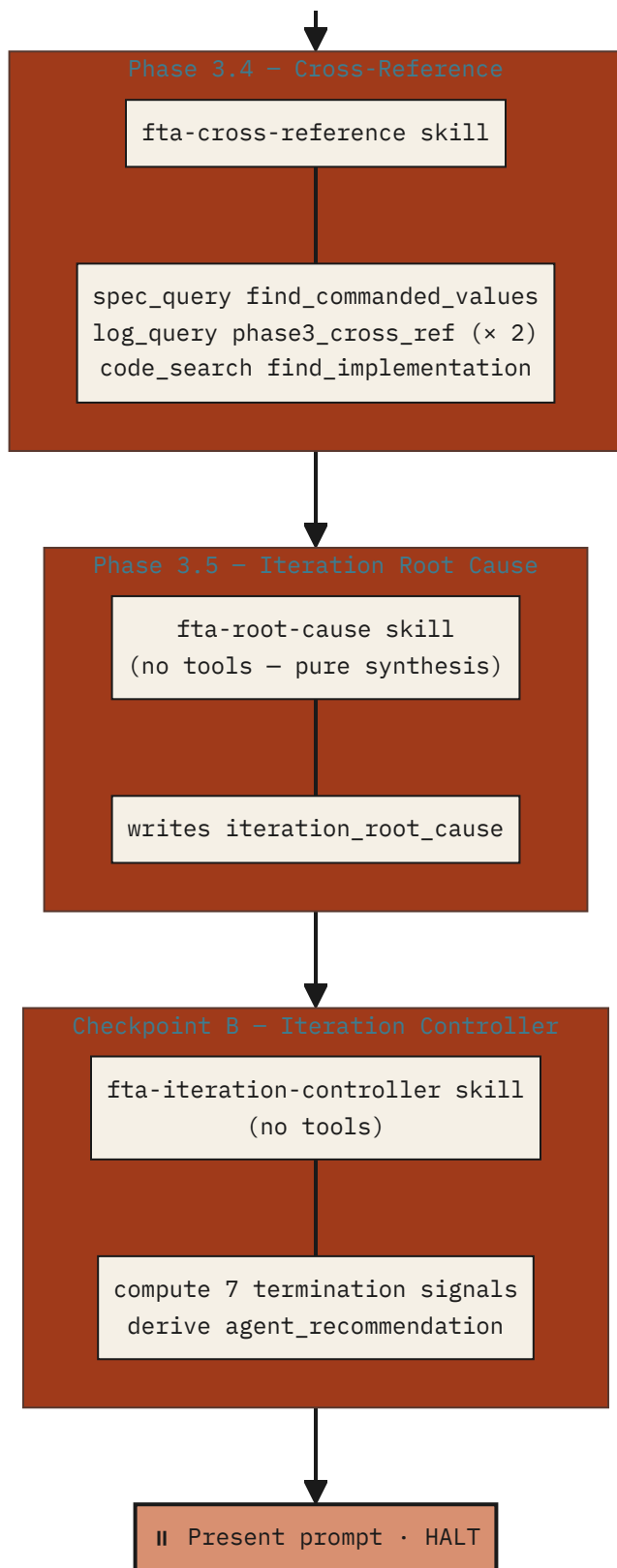
§07 Per-iteration FTA flow

Within a single iteration, five phase sub-steps run in sequence. Below each box: the skill that owns the step and the Python tools it invokes.

FIG. 5 — ONE FTA ITERATION INTERNAL FLOW

FIG-05





ANTI-LAZINESS INVARIANTS (PRESERVED FROM V3+)

- **All branches evaluated** – Gate A processes every top-level branch even if one already shows failure
- **All failure modes evaluated** – Gate B processes every expanded failure mode even if one is confirmed
- **Table isolation enforced at the script layer** – log_query.py refuses Phase 1/2 queries against UE_Trace_log
- **Keyword provenance auto-appended** – every tool invocation logs which keywords it produced and which iteration they belong to

§08 Skill I/O reference

What each skill reads from the state file, what it writes back, and which Python tools it invokes. This is the contract surface – any change to a skill must preserve these I/O shapes or all downstream consumers break.

SKILL	PHASE	INPUT (READS FROM STATE FILE)
3gpp-rca-orchestrator INIT MODE	0	engineer_input (from CLI) duckdb_path, tool_dir
3gpp-scoping	1	meta.engineer_input
3gpp-event-timeline V6	2	phase1_scope_filter
3gpp-top-event-confirmation CHKPT A	A	phase2_ecf.top_event_candidates phase2_ecf.observable_symptoms.log_coverage user_action (RECORD mode only)
3gpp-fta-build-tree V6	3.1	iteration_id (param) phase1_scope_filter fta_iterations[iter-1].input_top_event

SKILL	PHASE	INPUT (READS FROM STATE FILE)
3gpp-fta-evaluate-branches V6	3.2/3.3	iteration_id (param) fta_iterations[iter-1].hybrid_tree phase2_ecf.observable_symptoms.missing_events
3gpp-fta-cross-reference V6	3.4	iteration_id (param) fta_iterations[iter-1].base_events[] fta_iterations[iter-1].hybrid_tree (parent branches)
3gpp-fta-root-cause V6	3.5	iteration_id (param) full fta_iterations[iter-1] slice (tree, base_events, cross_ref findings, etc)
3gpp-fta-iteration-controller CHKPT B	B	iteration_id (param) fta_iterations[iter-1] (full) all prior fta_iterations[*] (for cross-iteration signals) meta.iteration_budget user_action (RECORD mode)
3gpp-rca-orchestrator FINALIZE MODE	4	Full state file (only place a full read occurs)

SKILL	PHASE	INPUT (READS FROM STATE FILE)
—— Retrieval wrapper skills (thin pass-through)		
3gpp-spec-retrieval WRAPPER	multi	operation + op-specific args (from caller)
3gpp-code-retrieval WRAPPER	multi	operation + op-specific args (from caller)
3gpp-log-queries WRAPPER	multi	phase_tag + table + keywords + filters (from caller)

STATE FILE SLICE-READ DISCIPLINE

Every skill reads *only* the slice it needs. Loading the full state file is reserved for orchestrator finalize. This keeps token usage proportional to the iteration depth, not to total run history. A 5-iteration run with a Phase 3 retry should still fit in the context window because no single skill needs to see more than its own iteration plus the immediate predecessor.

§09 Python tool I/O reference

Each Python tool exposes multiple *operations* selected by a CLI flag. Every invocation receives `--state-file` and writes structured output to the relevant section directly; stdout returns a compressed JSON summary for the skill to inspect. **Tool scripts also auto-append to `keyword_provenance_audit`** – this is how anti-hallucination invariants are enforced mechanically rather than by skill discipline.

SPEC_QUERY.PY – 3GPP SPEC GRAPHRAG (6 OPERATIONS)

--OPERATION	REQUIRED ARGS	STDOUT SHAPE (COMPRESSED)	STATE FILE DESTINATION
skeleton	<code>--procedure</code> <code>--rat</code> <code>--top-event</code>	<code>phases[] (id, name, spec_ref, mandatory_messages, layer) gate_at_top, spec_refs[]</code>	<code>fta_iterations[N-1].hyt.spec_skeleton_source</code>
lightweight_procedure	<code>--procedure</code> <code>--rat</code> <code>--need is_is_not ecf</code>	<code>is_is_not: primary_layers, key_timers, initiating_message, spec_refs ecf: expected_flow[order, message, direction, layer]</code>	<code>is_is_not → phase1_scope_filter.spec ecf → phase2_ecf.observable_s.expected_flow_source</code>
extract_ies	<code>--message -</code> <code>--procedure</code> <code>--spec-ref</code> <code>-- hypothesis-id</code>	<code>message_definitions[] (name, mandatory_ies, optional_ies, direction)</code>	<code>phase3_evaluations[id].spec_ie_extraction</code>

--OPERATION	REQUIRED ARGS	STDOUT SHAPE (COMPRESSED)	STATE FILE DESTINATION
find_commanded_values	--base- event-name --base- event-layer --upstream- messages	commanded_value_ies[] (ie_name, message, meaning, spec_ref, ue_action, range_unit)	fta_iterations[N- 1].cross_reference _findings[id].commanded
generate_hypotheses <i>fallback</i>	--event -- procedure - -rat	hypotheses[] (id, cause, spec_ref, gate, ie_names, message_names, layer)	fta_iterations[N-1].hyb (when skeleton empty)
expand_sub-causes <i>fallback</i>	--parent- cause -- parent- spec-ref --procedure	sub-causes_exist (bool) sub-causes[] (cause, spec_ref, gate, ie_names, message_names)	fta_iterations[N-1].hyb .branches[id].children

CODE_SEARCH.PY – UE CODEBASE SEMANTIC SEARCH (3 OPERATIONS)

--OPERATION	REQUIRED ARGS	STDOUT SHAPE (COMPRESSED)	STATE FILE DESTINATION
bind_module	--phase- name -- phase-ref --scope- layer	modules[] (file, primary_function, relevance, evidence)	fta_iterations[N-1].hybr .branches[id].modules

--OPERATION	REQUIRED ARGS	STDOUT SHAPE (COMPRESSED)	STATE FILE DESTINATION
expand_failure_modes	--module -- phase- context	failure_modes[] (id_suffix, name, detection_code, log_keywords*, log_tags*, function_signature, layer) * literal macro strings, NEVER inferred	fta_iterations[N-1].hybrid .branches[id].children[]
find_implementation	-- hypothesis- cause --spec-ie- names -- scope- procedure --scope- layer	found (bool), confidence log_keywords*, log_tags* function_names, implementation_files evidence_summary	fta_iterations[N- 1].cross_reference _findings[id].actual_value

LOG MACRO LITERAL EXTRACTION (CRITICAL)

All log_keywords returned by code_search.py are **literal strings** extracted from these exact macros – never inferred from naming conventions:

```
MSG_HIGH(...) · NAS_MSG_HIGH(...) · LOG_MSG(code, ...) · QCRIL_LOG_DEBUG(...) ·  
RRC_LOG_MSG(level, ...) ·  
SYS_ERR(...) · DS_MSG_HIGH_1(...) · printf("[TAG] ...") · fprintf(stderr, ...) ·  
syslog(level, ...)
```

LOG_QUERY.PY – DUCKDB QUERY (5 PHASE TAGS)

Table isolation is enforced at script entry. Mismatched --phase-tag + --table combinations exit with code 3 and a policy violation JSON. The script *refuses* the query rather than letting downstream skills bypass the rule.

-- PHASE - TAG	ALLOWED -- TABLE	CALLER SKILL	-- RET VALUE
phase1	UE_3gpp_signaling_log ONLY	3gpp-scoping	no
phase2	UE_3gpp_signaling_log ONLY	3gpp-event-timeline	no
phase3_gate_a	UE_3gpp_signaling_log ONLY	3gpp-fta-evaluate-branches	no
phase3_gate_b	UE_Trace_log ONLY	3gpp-fta-evaluate-branches	no
phase3_cross_ref	EITHER (caller specifies)	3gpp-fta-cross-reference	yes (

EXIT CODE CONVENTIONS (UNIFORM ACROSS ALL THREE PYTHON TOOLS)

0	Success – stdout valid JSON, state file updated
1	Invalid args (bug in calling skill – halt with error)
2	Tool unavailable (backend down – halt pipeline)
3	Policy violation (e.g. table isolation – never retry)
4	Empty result (valid; caller decides fallback)

§10 State file ownership

Single state file at /tmp/rca_state_<ts>.json . Path is stored at .rca/current_state_path.txt . Every section has exactly one write owner (multiple readers); this matrix is the cross-reference for any debugging session.

STATE FILE SECTION	WRITTEN BY
meta.*	3gpp-rca-orchestrator (init)
meta.current_phase	Every skill on entry/exit
phase1_scope_filter	3gpp-scoping
phase2_ecf.top_event	3gpp-top-event-confirmation
phase2_ecf.observable_symptoms	3gpp-event-timeline
phase2_ecf.top_event_candidates[]	3gpp-event-timeline V6
phase2_ecf.user_confirmation	3gpp-top-event-confirmation V6
user_decisions[]	3gpp-top-event-confirmation, 3gpp-fta-iteration-controller V6

STATE	FILE	SECTION	WRITTEN BY
fta_	iterations[i].	input_top_event	3gpp-rca-orchestrator (iter 1) <i>or</i> 3gpp-fta-iteration-controller (iter ≥ 2)
fta_	iterations[i].	hybrid_tree	3gpp-fta-build-tree
fta_	iterations[i].	pruned_branches, base_events, rejected, open_items	3gpp-fta-evaluate-branches
fta_	iterations[i].	cross_reference_findings[]	3gpp-fta-cross-reference
fta_	iterations[i].	iteration_root_cause	3gpp-fta-root-cause
fta_	iterations[i].	agent_recommendation	3gpp-fta-iteration-controller V6
fta_	iterations[i].	user_decision	3gpp-fta-iteration-controller V6
phase3_	root_cause_chain		3gpp-fta-iteration-controller (on accept_terminal) V6

STATE FILE SECTION	WRITTEN BY
phase4_rca_report	3gpp-rca-orchestrator (finalize)
keyword_provenance_audit[]	All three Python tools (auto-append)

§11 Discussion topics for the review

These are open risks and design choices worth re-examining with the team. None of them are blockers for v6.0 – but each is a place where v6 could surprise us in production, and the team's experience may shift our position.

Q1 – RUBBER-STAMPING RISK

WILL ENGINEERS ACTUALLY ENGAGE WITH CHECKPOINTS, OR JUST TYPE "CONFIRM" AND MOVE ON?

v6's value proposition rests on engineers reviewing the agent's evidence at each checkpoint. If review becomes a reflex acceptance, we've added user-pause cost without buying snowball-error prevention. The checkpoint presentation format (`_shared/checkpoint-presentation-formats.md`) shows full evidence and rationale to make engaged review easier than blind acceptance – but discipline still matters. **Question for the team:** do we need additional friction (e.g. requiring a rationale string when accepting) for high-stakes runs?

Q2 – ITERATION BUDGET AND RUNAWAY PREVENTION

IS 5 THE RIGHT DEFAULT? IS THE BUDGET-NEAR-EXHAUSTION HEURISTIC STRONG ENOUGH?

Default 5 should cover typical depth-2 to depth-4 chains comfortably. The controller's recommendation logic forces `accept_terminal` when budget-1 is reached, but users can still override. **Question:** should we treat budget exhaustion as a hard wall (no override allowed) for non-admin engineers, or trust the override-confirmation flow?

Q3 – CODE-IMPLEMENTATION FLOOR DETECTION

THE CONTROLLER TERMINATES WHEN ≥ 2 SIGNALS FIRE (SAME FILE ACROSS ITERS, SINGLE-BRANCH TREE, NO COMMANDED IES, ETC). IS THE HEURISTIC RIGHT?

Termination signals are mechanical, listed in `references/recommendation-logic.md`. In testing we may find that some real failures naturally fire 2+ signals at iteration 2 (e.g. a clear PHY bug isolated to one module). That's fine – `accept_terminal` is the right recommendation, user can still dig if needed. **Question:** should we keep this set of 7 signals as v6.0 baseline, or wait for real-run data before locking them in?

Q4 – CROSS-ITERATION CROSS-REFERENCE (D5 DEFERRED)

V6 BASELINE DOES NOT CROSS-REFERENCE ITERATION N'S FINDINGS AGAINST ITERATION N-1'S COMMANDED VALUES. SHOULD V6.1 ADD THIS?

Scenario: iter 1 finds `VALUE_DISCREPANCY` at P2.2 (commanded -110 dBm, actual -10 dBm). User digs into P2.2; iter 2 finds an `ABSENCE` in

`dsp_calc_preamble_tx_power`. Today, iter 2 does *not* automatically re-verify that the iter 1 commanded value was correctly received by the DSP layer. **Question:** is this gap real (worth v6.1 work) or theoretical (rarely matters in practice)?

Q5 – HARD TERMINATION AT VERIFIED ROOT CAUSE

V3+ INVARIANT: PIPELINE NEVER PRODUCES FIX RECOMMENDATIONS. STILL RIGHT FOR V6?

The boundary remains: pipeline produces root cause + causal chain + evidence + audit; downstream engineering processes own fix design. Phase 4 orchestrator validates that no string in the state file contains "fix:", "recommendation:", "patch:", etc. **Question:** any pressure from product/customers to soften this and have the agent propose code changes? If yes, that's a different product, not a v6.1.

Q6 – STATE FILE LIFECYCLE

STATE FILES AT `/TMP/` ACCUMULATE. CLEANUP POLICY?

v6 doesn't auto-delete state files after completion – they're preserved for audit.

`.rca/current_state_path.txt` points to the most recent. Long-running engineers

may end up with dozens of historical state files. **Question:** add a `/rca cleanup` sub-command? Or rely on OS tmp cleanup? Or move state file out of `/tmp/` entirely?

Q7 – FAILURE RECOVERY FROM PARTIAL ITERATION

IF CLINE CRASHES MID-ITERATION (BETWEEN GATE A AND GATE B), DOES THE NEXT /RCA PICK UP CORRECTLY?

State machine is `iteration_N_running` during the entire iteration. Workflow dispatches by re-running the iteration from build-tree; phase skills are designed to be idempotent (they check if their output is already populated before redoing work). **Question for testing:** we should verify this empirically – what's the smoke test for crash-resume?

Q8 – MOBILE / SHARED REVIEW

RCA REPORTS INCLUDE CAUSAL CHAINS ACROSS ITERATIONS. ARE THEY READABLE FOR SOMEONE NOT IN THE RUN?

Report template (`_shared/rca-report-template.md`) renders Section 4 as the chain plus per-iteration detail in Section 3. Length: 5–7 pages for a 3-iteration run. **Question:** should we add a 1-page TL;DR header (final root cause + chain only) for engineers who just want the punch-line?